Revision Date:
June 1, 2026

Background:
Organ transplant patients must take medications to avoid rejection of the new organ. The Organ Transplant Anti-Rejection Medications (OTAM) program provides state-only restricted scope Medi-Cal coverage with no Share of Cost (SOC) for up to two years following an organ transplant to cover medications.

Purpose:
This section provides guidance on the OTAM program. It was reformatted, no other changes in policy were made.

Policy:
Eligibility Requirements
To be eligible for OTAM a Medi-Cal beneficiary must have had an organ transplant within two years, and either:

- Was or will be discontinued from zero SOC or California Children's Services (CCS)-based Medi-Cal and have no Medicare or private health insurance that covers OTAM, or
- Is eligible for restricted benefits and has no CCS-based Medi-Cal, Medicare or private health insurance that covers OTAM.

When determining eligibility for this program, there are no other verification requirements.

Note: A beneficiary may be eligible to this program more than once. They may be eligible for up to two years from the date of their most recent transplant. This program does not cover any physicians' office visits.

Referral Source
An evaluation for this program is initiated when:

- A Department of Health Care Services (DHCS) referral has been received
- The customer contacts the county:
  - by calling Access
  - visiting a Family Resource Center (FRC)
  - answering "yes" to the following question from the health program information and referrals section on the renewal form: "Has any household member living in the home received an organ transplant within the last 2 years?"

Required Verification of Transplant Date
The customer's organ transplant date can be determined by the date on the DHCS referral. If it is not listed on the DHCS referral, a letter from the treating physician must be requested. The letter must include:

- their letterhead and National Provider Identifier (NPI)
- the name of the individual
- the date of the most recent organ transplant

Retroactive Coverage
There is no retroactive coverage for this program unless the county fails to act on the notification of possible OTAM eligibility.

Change in Circumstances (CIC) and Medi-Cal Eligibility Data System (MEDS) Alerts
Benefits must be re-evaluated when a customer reports a CIC that affects eligibility to this program, or a MEDS alert is generated. There is no annual renewal required for this program.

Examples of relevant reported changes would be:
- Any change that would make the beneficiary eligible to a zero SOC Medi-Cal program
- Obtaining Medicare or other private insurance that covers OTAM
- Loss of California residence
- Death

Aid Codes and Notices of Action (NOA)
The Aid Code for OTAM is 77. The appropriate NOA's for the OTAM program are:
- Approval for Organ Transplant Anti-Rejection Medication (MC 378)
- Discontinuance for Organ Transplant Anti-Rejection Medication Program (MC 379)

Note: A denial NOA does not exist for this program. If the individual does not cooperate or is not eligible, their Medi-Cal case discontinues if no other eligibility exists.

References:
ACWDL 11-02

Procedure:
Please refer to Processing Guide 14 Organ Transplant Anti-Rejection Medications Program.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by May 31, 2029.

Approval for Release:


Alberto Banuelos, Ph.D., Interim Director
Self-Sufficiency Services